Fundamental Duties Article (51A)

- Inspired by the Constitution of the USSR
- 10 Duties added by 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976
- Located in Part IV-A of the Constitution
- Recommended by Swaran Singh Committee
- Verma Committee on Fundamental Duties (1999)
  - To assess the status of Fundamental Duties in India and suggest ways to implement them in practical terms.
- 86th Amendment Act, 2002
  - Added the 11th Fundamental Duty:
    - To provide opportunities for education to one's child or ward between the ages of 6 and 14 years.
    - Aligns with the Right to Education Act (Article 21A) introduced by the same amendment.

The list of 11 Fundamental Duties under Article 51-A

- Art. 51A(f) - To value and preserve the rich heritage of the country's composite culture,
- Art. 51A(e) - To promote harmony and the spirit of common brotherhood amongst all the people of India transcending religious, linguistic, and regional or sectional diversities and to renounce practices derogatory to the dignity of women,
- Art. 51A(d) - To defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so,
- Art. 51A(c) - To uphold and protect the sovereignty, unity, and integrity of India,
- Art. 51A(b) - To cherish and follow the noble ideals that inspired the national struggle for freedom,
- Art. 51A(a) - To abide by the Constitution and respect its ideals and institutions, the National Flag and the National Anthem,
- Art. 51A(g) - To protect and improve the natural environment including forests, lakes, rivers, and wildlife, and to have compassion for living creatures,
- Art. 51A(h) - To develop a scientific temper, humanism, and the spirit of inquiry and reform,
- Art. 51A(i) - To safeguard public property and to abjure violence,
- Art. 51A(j) - To strive towards excellence in all spheres of individual and collective activity so that the nation constantly rises to higher levels of endeavor and achievement, and
- Art. 51A(k) - To provide opportunities for education to his child or ward between the age of six and fourteen years (added by the 86th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2002).

Significance of Fundamental Duties

- Promotes Civic Responsibility
- Fosters Nationalism.
- Environmental Protection
- Non-Justiciable Nature
- Cultural Preservation
- Balance of Rights and Duties